Game development - Comfy Jam Autumn 2026.10 Report

Tommaso Mattei

October 2026

Contents

1 Introduction **2**

2 Walk-in' Bakery **3**

3 Score and feedback analysis **4**
3.1 Score 4
3.2 Feedback Analysis 4
3.2.1 Audio 4
3.2.2 Art 5
3.2.3 Gameplay 5
3.2.4 Limitation 5
3.2.5 Polish 5
3.2.6 Theme 5

4 Conclusion **5**
4.1 Criteria 5
4.2 End 6

1 Introduction

Comfy Jam Autumn was a game jam that went on from October 3 to October 17 of 2026. The theme of the game jam was comfy, with the limitation of: "Things Change When You Look Away". The total participants were 231. After the end of the submission period there was a one week time frame for rating the games. The scoring system used had stars and they went from 1 to 5 for each category. The categories were: Audio, Art, Gameplay, Limitation, Polish and Theme. There were winners for each category but also an overall winner by averaging over all of them.



Figure 1: Comfy Jam Autumn

2 Walk-in' Bakery

The team made of Twigs and Zaphis created their second game together, Walk-In' Bakery, a cozy cooking game with an autumn theme and moving ingredients walking around the place. Here's a link to the itch.io game page (https://twigs-28.itch.io/walk-in-bakery). Below, the main menu of the game.



Figure 2: The main menu of Walk-in' Bakery

The game plays as a normal cooking game in 3D, with the possibility of using tools and taking items to put them into cooking appliances. Everything is physics based and an interaction system is hard coded for each element. The goal is to complete recipes and bring them to the counter.

3 Score and feedback analysis

Below, the final rankings and the rating distribution over 9 ratings, ending up overall in 147th place, being in the top 63.63%. To be completely transparent, if the raw score was not so negatively adjusted by being under the median 12 reviews, the actual final position would be in 99th place, with the top 42.85%.

Table 1: Criteria Rankings and Scores (Ranked from 9 ratings)

Criteria	Rank	Score(Lowered)	Raw Score
Limitation	#92	3.062	3.750
Audio	#106	2.960	3.625
Art	#142	2.960	3.625
Theme	#147	2.858	3.500
Overall	#147	2.637	3.229
Polish	#175	2.041	2.500
Gameplay	#186	1.939	2.375

3.1 Score

The best scoring category category was Limitation, with a 3.062 score and the 92th place, showing how the idea was novel enough, being the most prominent aspect for the players.

The second higher ranking was the audio, with a 2.960 score and the 106th place. This is a relevant result since in the last jam audio was one of the worst categories. This time around more time was allocated to finding the right musics and sound effects.

The third place was occupied by the Art, with a 2.960 score and the 142th place, which is a good result, showing a coherent style and look for the cozy aspect of the jam.

In fourth place we have Theme, with a 2.858 score and the 147th place. This is a perfectly fine score, meaning that the concept was good enough without being outstanding.

From the fifth place and downwards this was under the curve for our overall score, meaning that these categories diminished the final rank.

Polish had a score of 2.041 and the 175th place. Since the game itself was way more complex to the simpler hack and slash of the Dollhouse, the overall polish wasn't good, even with twice the time. To fulfill the goal of the game, development did not stop until the last minute, leaving no room for polishing whatsoever. In the final game, many bugs and physiscs based anomalies appeared, showing up consistently.

In last place we have Gameplay, with a score of 1.939 and the 186th place. This is the worst performance yet by far, meaning that the lack of polish and clunkiness of the gameplay was too big to ignore. The main goal was to make the game cozy, so we focused on artistic and musical aspects which weren't as strong in our first project. Focusing on that didn't leave a lot of room for improving or even playtesting the game. Making a cooking game fun and cozy is possible, but too much clunkiness and unintuitiveness will not allow anyone to have fun at all, meaning that the game itself was barely playable. If i had to guess, not a single person managed to make a servicable plate of chestnuts.

3.2 Feedback Analysis

Under the game's entry in the game jam page we received 6 comments containing feedback and impressions about the game, which can truly give us insight on the experience the players had and the reasoning behind the scores without having to guess. This section is divided with the same criteria used for scoring. If a single comment touches multiple aspects it will be mentioned in all of them.

3.2.1 Audio

1 person said that they liked the audio.

A comment mentioned how the music was relaxing.

3.2.2 Art

4 people said that they liked the visual aspect of the game.

A comment mentioned the art style being adorable.

2 comments said that the modeling and textures of the game were nice.

A comment said that the bakery and food was great looking.

3.2.3 Gameplay

0 people said that they liked the gameplay.

A comment mentioned how the physics made playing the game incredibly difficult, knocking everything down.

A comment said how they forgot how the game worked and to view the tutorial again they had to restart. It also got confused by some misleading flavor in the tutorial text. The same comment added how the physics lunched him all over the place. The gameplay for him was confusing, and a bug with the food falling through happened.

3.2.4 Limitation

6 people said that they liked the implementation of the limitation.

A comment thought that it was hilarious how the items would move and then stop when looked at.

A comment thought that the idea for the limitation was neat.

A comment said that the ingredients moving was really funny.

A comment said that the little legs of the items were funny.

3.2.5 Polish

0 people said that the game was polished.

A comment thought that the unreal physics were fighting against the game itself.

A comment said that the game made them dizzy...what?

A comment said that they got slapped around by the character's hands while running. It also said how jumping clipped the camera. Numerous important items were lost inside the floor or other items.

Another comment mentioned seeing the model while jumping. It also said that he didn't get to cut the chestnuts even when on the board.

3.2.6 Theme

2 people said that they liked the theme.

2 comments mentioned liking the idea.

4 Conclusion

The feedback itself clarifies the reason behind the scores and gives suggestion towards which way to improve the game itself.

4.1 Criteria

The theme was good, and coupled with the clever implementation and presentation of the limitation, the game felt coherent with itself.

This time around the audio worked, implementing both sound effects and main themes for the game and the menus.

The art style was coherent and well done to communicate the simple and cozy feeling of autumn, without any problem.

The theme of running a bakery was nothing ground breaking but perfectly fine for the game jam.

Gameplay and polish should be talked about together, since everything else was well polished besides it. The scope and the order of features for the game did create a situation for which polish was almost impossible. The greatest problem was getting the game to work in tandem with the limitation,

anything beyond that didn't have enouh time for itself. The basic gameplay idea of simulating the cooking of a dish is perfect for a cozy game, however the combination of disruptive physics and high presence of game breaking bugs led to this result. Many playtests were planned for the project but focusing too much on getting a working product with a good amount of content made us fall short, resulting in no playetests whatsoever. If more tests were done, in tandem with a better responsiveness and intuitiveness than the gameplay, while not terribly interesting, would at least have been non disruptive for the cozy atmosphere.

4.2 End

While we managed to improve on many aspects that were lacking with the Dollhouse, a simpler project, the decisive lack of polish and iterations over the gameplay showed, resulting in a way lower placement. In addition to that, without knowing about the score being lowered for having few reviews, we did not have the possibility of improving the final scores to at least decent level.

Even if this is a failure, there is still a lot to learn from this. For the next projects a focus on creating a base experience and iterating over that without focusing too much on the amount of content should be paramount.